📉 The Great Depression: Depression Stations · ANSWER KEY

US History · Unit 10 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · Day 11 · culture of the 1930s

Name: _____

Go to each station. Answer the questions there.

Station 1: Folk music, Woody Guthrie

1. Dust pneumonia: what illness do his Dust Bowl songs describe, and how did it affect people?
A lung illness from breathing fine dust; coughing, sickness and death, especially for children and the elderly.

2. What message does his song about going to California give farmers?
California only welcomes people with money; migrants faced low pay and hostility.

3. Why would Guthrie sing “This Land Is Your Land” in hard times?
To say the country belongs to everyone, including the poor; a protest and a hope.

Station 2: The Columbia River and Grand Coulee Dam

4. Guthrie’s Columbia River songs (1941) describe a place in the Pacific Northwest. Where is it, and how does it connect to the New Deal?
The Columbia River and Grand Coulee Dam in Washington; a New Deal public-works project that created jobs, irrigation and cheap power.

Station 3: Letters to the Roosevelts

5. Fill in the table.

Letter	Who wrote it?	What did they ask for?	What does it show about Americans’ worries?
1	**Answers vary by letter**	**jobs, clothes, money, help keeping a home**	**fear of losing homes and jobs; hunger**
2			
3			
4			

6. Why would so many people write to the President or First Lady for help?
FDR’s fireside chats and Eleanor’s travels made them feel personal and caring; local help had run out.

Station 4: Film, photos and art

7. Why were Snow White, Orphan Annie and Shirley Temple popular in the 1930s?
They offered hope and escape; stories of kids and good people winning through hard times.

🔑 *Key written by our team, please check.*